

Feeling blue

Neptune is made of the same gases as Uranus. It also gets its rich coloring from the sunlight shining on the methane gas. Neptune's color is more intense because we can see into its atmosphere. We can also see dark and light spots on its surface.

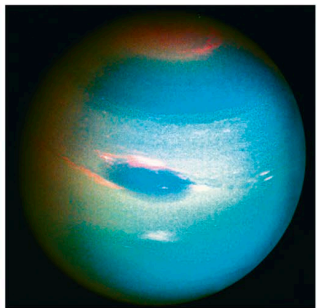
Neptune's rings are very dim.

One white patch on Neptune travels so fast that it has been nicknamed "Scooter."

Neptune is the windiest planet in the Solar System.

White spots are clouds of methane ice.

The Great Dark Spot is a huge storm. It is almost as big as planet Earth.



Racing round

Neptune's dark and white spots all travel around the planet at different speeds. Sometimes they are close together, while at other times they are apart.



Order of the planets

Make up a sentence using the first letter of each of the main planets' names to help you remember their order out from the Sun. Start with "M" for the first planet—Mercury. For example: **Many Very Elderly Men Just Snooze Under Newspapers.**